DSDM Practise :

- Facilitated Workshops
- Modelling
- Iterative Development

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Outline

- Other DSDM Practices :
  - Facilitated Workshops
  - Modelling
  - Iterative Development

Facilitated Workshops

*"A structured group meeting to enable participants to reach a predetermined objective in a compressed time frame, supported by a **neutral facilitator**."*

Success Factors

- Effective, trained, independent Workshop Facilitator
- Flexibility in format, within clearly defined objectives
- Thorough preparation (by Facilitator and Participants)
- Ability to build in outputs from previous workshops
- Decisions and agreements not forced
- Workshop report distributed to participants soon afterwards



Facilitated Workshops

*"A structured group meeting to enable participants to reach a predetermined objective in a compressed time frame, supported by a **neutral facilitator**."*

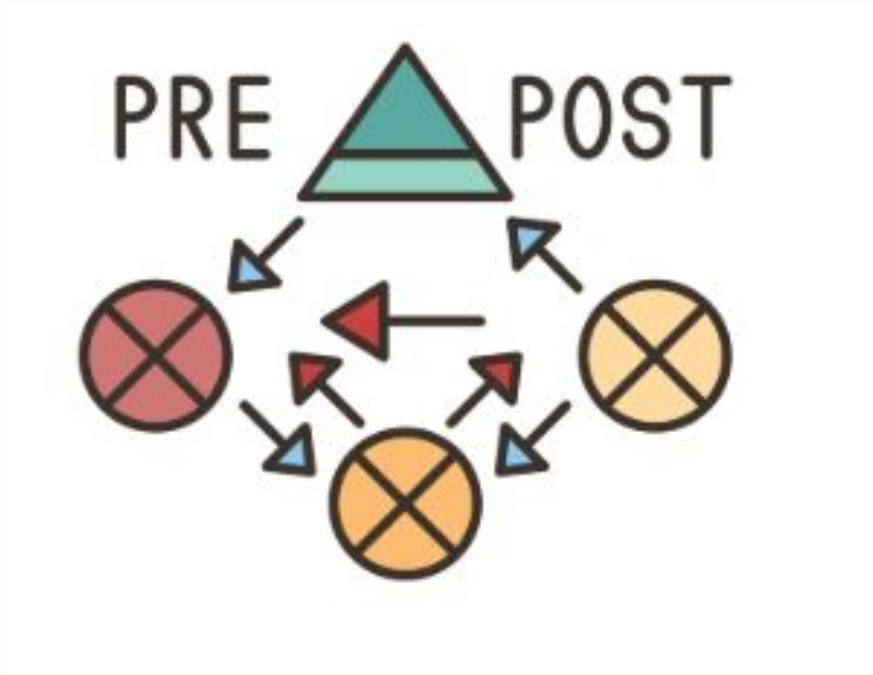


Benefits

- Rapid, high quality team decisions
- Greater buy-in and ownership from all stakeholders
- Clarification of issues and enhanced communication
- Building team spirit and consensus

Key DSDM Practice: Modelling

- Visual representation of problem or solution
- Description or analogy to help visualise something that cannot be directly observed.
- A small but exact copy of something
- A pattern or figure of something to be made
- Often used to describe a set of diagrams



Key DSDM Practice: Modelling

Purpose of Modelling

- Improves communication and prompts the right questions.
- Helps confirm expectations, test achievability of objectives, and validate requirements.
- Makes solution elements visible early (e.g., diagrams, prototypes, mock-ups).
- Should only be detailed enough to serve the purpose—avoid unnecessary effort.
- Often involves **abstraction**: omitting details to focus on specific aspects.



Modelling Perspectives

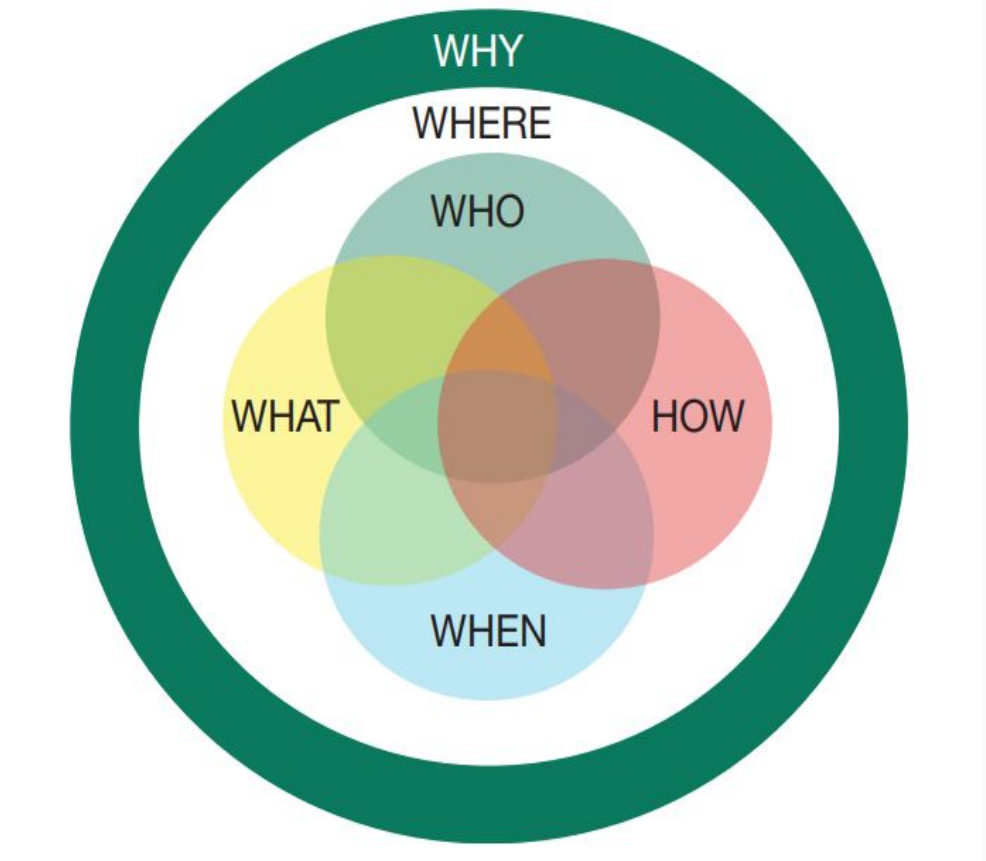
- Provides a **coherent picture of a solution area**.
- Considers perspectives: **What, How, Where, Who, When, Why**.
- Shows relationships between these perspectives.

Key DSDM Practice: Modelling

Diagram: Modelling Perspectives

A Venn diagram shows the six perspectives:

- **WHAT** – Information within the solution area (data, relationships, business rules).
- **HOW** – Functions, features, and processes.
- **WHERE** – Locations of business operations (in relation to the solution).
- **WHO** – People (customers, users, stakeholders).
- **WHEN** – Events important to the business (time, scheduling).
- **WHY** – Business objectives and strategy.



Key DSDM Practice: Iterative Development

- Solution evolves through cycles of iterative development
- Each cycle moves solution from high-level concept closer to something with acknowledged business value
- Each cycle should be:
  - As short as possible
  - Only as formal as necessary
- Typically after an initial conversation, follow cycles of

Thought, Action and Conversation

Key DSDM Practice: Iterative Development

Planning Iterative Development

- Strategy decided during **Foundations phase**
- Large solution broken into **small manageable chunks**
- Work delivered in **Timeboxes** (short, fixed periods)
- Each Timebox contains prioritized requirements/user stories
- **Benefits**:
  - Easier progress tracking
  - Faster delivery of usable increments
  - Reduced project risks

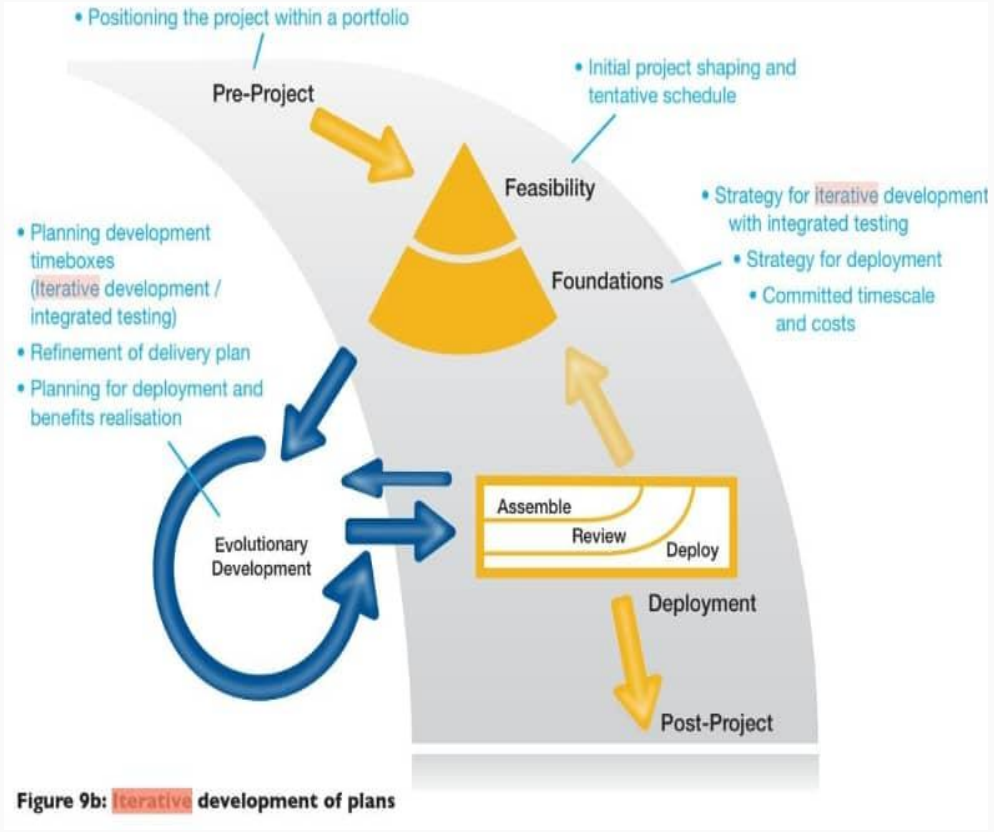


Figure 9b: Iterative development of plans

Key DSDM Practice: Iterative Development

Controlling Iterative Development



- Each cycle delivers **incremental improvements**
- Reviews may show:
  - Wrong evolution of solution
  - Changing business needs
  - New issues discovered
- **Configuration Management** ensures correct versions and stability
- **Benefits**:
  - Maintains solution integrity
  - Encourages flexibility and adaptability

Key DSDM Practice: Iterative Development



Quality in Iterative Development

- Core rule: **Never compromise quality**
- Quality defined **early** and verified **continuously**
- **Verification methods**:
  - **Reviews (static):** check documents, designs, code
  - **Testing (dynamic):** run deliverables to confirm behavior
- **Benefits**:
  - Detects defects early
  - Builds stakeholder confidence
  - Ensures solution is **fit for purpose**

Key DSDM Practice: Iterative Development

Reviews & Testing

- **Reviews**: from informal peer checks → structured formal reviews
- **Types of Tests**:
  - **Positive** – confirm expected behavior
  - **Negative** – block invalid actions
  - **Unhappy Path** – test unusual cases
- **Good tests include**:
  - Starting state
  - Set of actions
  - Expected outcome
- **Benefits**:
  - Improves reliability
  - Reduces risk of failure



Key DSDM Practice: Iterative Development

Roles & Responsibilities

- **Technical Coordinator**
  - Ensures quality from technical perspective
  - Validates non-functional requirements are met
  - Oversees technical reviews and rigorous testing

- **Solution Tester**
  - Responsible for most testing activities
  - Exceptions:
    - Business acceptance testing → Business Ambassadors/Advisors
    - Unit testing → Solution Developers
  - Provides testing knowledge & expertise to the team

Key DSDM Practice: Iterative Development

Iterative Development & Incremental Delivery

- Each Timebox should ideally deliver a **potentially deployable increment**
- Testing integrated into development & delivery process
- Benefits:
  - Reduces project risks
  - Supports early **return on investment** through incremental delivery



Key DSDM Practice: Iterative Development

Investigate, Refine, Consolidate (IRC)

- Used for each requirement/user story/product
- **Investigate** – understand details, define acceptance criteria
- **Refine** – develop and enhance solution
- **Consolidate** – converge on accurate solution
- Helps avoid excessive iterations
- Reviews scheduled within Timebox → maintain business focus & stakeholder engagement

Questions on other practises?



EXERCISES

1. What is Iterative Development?

   a) A practice where features are designed, developed and tested
   b) A gated process where development can not begin until the finished design is complete
   c) An early sample, model or release of a product to test a concept or process
   d) The process and activity of planning, organizing, motivating and controlling resources to achieve a specific goal

1. In a free format Timebox, which activity is carried out during the Iterative Development step?

   a) Agree what work will be undertaken, agree priorities and accept the workload
   b) Scheduled reviews of the work in progress
   c) Formal acceptance of the Timebox deliverables
   d) Workshop to learn from experience and to take action to improve future Timeboxes

EXERCISES

3. During Iterative Development, which testing activity is the responsibility of the Solution Tester?

   a) Business acceptance testing
   b) Unit testing of a feature
   c) Ensuring that testing is sufficiently comprehensive
   d) Providing testing knowledge and expertise

4. When using Iterative Development, what should each cycle begin and end with?

   a) Complete solution
   b) Conversation
   c) Facilitated Workshop
   d) Timebox

EXERCISES

5. Identify the missing word(s) in the following sentence:

   A DSDM project will always deliver a viable solution, as long as the practices of [?] and Timeboxing are followed.

   a) Daily Stand-ups
   b) MoSCoW
   c) Iterative Development
   d) Incremental Delivery



THANK YOU

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